accommodating four or five boys. Some additional pupils attend the school without living in the hostel. There is also a girls' school, which can teach up to 400 children, though there is no hostel on the compound for them.[16] As one high-ranking JuD official could not help but point out, while the Taliban banned education for girls his organization provided education to them.[17]

In addition to the educational complex, the other major facilities are health-related. The Al Aziz Hospital has been operating since 1999 and offers general medicine, dentistry, optometry, general surgery and tibb, or traditional medicine. All doctors are said to be Bachelor of Medicine, Bachelor of Surgery [MBBS] and Fellowship of the College of Physicians and Surgeons [FCPS] qualified and to donate their time gratis. Patients are given free care, a bed, food and medicine for up to one year and their relatives are allowed to stay at Muridke free of charge to be with them, according to the hospital administrator. He boasted there was no equivalent service offered in sixty-six surrounding towns and told the author that he ventured out every week to inform people of the medical care on offer at Muridke. The group also arranged medical camps for those unable to travel to the hospital, and provided an ambulance service as well.[18] By the end of the decade, its social welfare offerings reached well beyond the confines of Muridke.

Initially the group's offerings consisted primarily of health care and education, which fell under the auspices of the Departments of Social Welfare and Education respectively. According to MDI's now-defunct website, the Al-Dawa Medical Mission was 'devoted to the service of the sick and the wounded that deserve proper medical treatment.' By 2001 it offered a host of services all free of charge. These included ten dispensaries in Muzaffarabad, Lahore and Sindh Province, all of which offered medical check-ups and medication. Twelve medical camps were also set up in 'far-off places', which lacked dispensaries or hospitals. In addition to the Taiba Hospital at Muridke, another was built in Muzaffarabad, which is the capital of Pakistan-administered Kashmir.[19] In one example of the way in which Lashkar blended its social welfare offerings with its jihadi activities, the group proselytized to doctors in the hopes of convincing them to volunteer their time at Medical Mission facilities *and* as medics for the mujahideen in Indian-administered Kashmir. It also selected students from